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Rainfall variability and farmer adaptation in Northern Ghana

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Abstract

This study examines how smallholder farmers in Northern Ghana perceive and respond to rainfall varia interviews with 40 farmers. Farmers reported later onset of rains and shorter seasons. Most adapted by drought-tolerant maize and diversifying livelihoods, but poorer households lacked the resources to adap

Keywords: climate change; adaptation; smallholder farmers

2. Methods

We conducted semi-structured interviews with 40 smallholder farmers in two districts of the Upper Wes

3. Findings

Farmers said the rains now start in late May rather than April, and dry spells within the season are long

Adaptation was shaped by access to credit, land and labour; women farmers faced the greatest constra